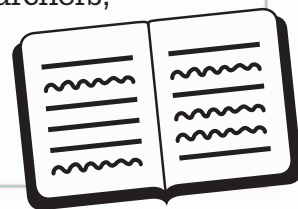




EDITOR

JOB DESCRIPTION

Editors of books and journals are responsible for the editorial content of their publications. In this role, your duties may range from evaluating manuscripts and commissioning writers to produce text, to checking text for accuracy, spelling, and grammar. Editors may work directly with subject experts, graphic designers, and picture researchers, and liaise with sales, marketing, or production staff to promote and print the publication.



SALARY

Editorial assistant ★★★★★

Editor ★★☆☆☆

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Strong competition for entry-level jobs • Low pay levels for junior roles • Book and journal publishers increasingly turning to online publication • Jobs in book publishing not always advertised

CAREER PATHS

Most editors enter publishing as editorial assistants, helping with research, fact-checking, and basic editorial tasks. With experience they can gain promotion to manage the publication of a book or journal, and then a “list”—a themed category—of books. Some editors diversify into other roles in publishing, such as marketing or management.



GRADUATE To become an editor, you need a degree in English or a subject related to the type of publishing you intend to specialize in. An internship with a publishing company will give you useful experience, and you can also take industry-accredited courses in editing and proofreading.

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **WRITER** *see pp. 52–53*
- ▶ **JOURNALIST** *see pp. 54–55*
- ▶ **ADVERTISING ACCOUNT EXECUTIVE** *see pp. 72–73*
- ▶ **FILM/VIDEO EDITOR** Assembles pictures and sound for film or television. A film or video editor needs a good sense of timing, attention to detail, and the ability to meet deadlines. Due to the competitive and fast-paced nature of the industry, technical skills and experience are valued just as highly as formal qualifications.



EDITOR After gaining experience at editorial assistant level, you can choose to specialize in a particular type of book or journal publishing.